EA-02-06-S
State CIO Adopted: 6/11/2026
TSB Approved: 6/11/2026
Sunset Review: 6/11/2028

Replaces:
N/A

WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

SECURE CONNECTIONS
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Secure Connections, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

SCOPE

The Secure Connections service capabilities listed in Section 4 must be used to access internal state resources. This enterprise service protects state network resources, systems, and data.

APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020) and their organizational users (including employees, contractors, partners, and vendors).

This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, legislature, judiciary, or local governments.

ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Secure Connection enterprise service designation encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Cloud Virtual Private Network (VPN) – provides a secure way to connect state employees to agency applications and other services hosted in a public cloud network using an Internet connection.
2. Internal Certificate Authority (ICA) – provides centrally governed trusted digital certificates for use inside the State Government Network (SGN) to address the need to protect data in transit.
3. Managed Firewall as a Service (FWaaS) – protects agency networks, systems, and workloads from unauthorized access and malicious attacks.
4. Office VPN (weblink) – provides a secure, cost-effective way to connect state employees to an agency's main network through a local Internet Service Provider (ISP).

5. Security Service Edge (SSE) – enterprise-managed security and access capability that delivers consistent, policy-based protection and secure connectivity for users, devices, and applications across on-premises, cloud, and remote environments.
6. User Virtual Private Network (SSL VPN) – provides remote users with secure Internet access to agency networks from any location.

WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver from compliance with this standard. No categorical exemptions apply.

AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants Washington Technology Solutions authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services. RCW 43.105.006 establishes Washington Technology Solutions as the centralized provider of broadly used and uniform technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Secure Connections
2. Definition of Terms Used in Policies and Reports.
3. EA-183.20.10 Identity Management User Authentication Standard.
4. EA-185.10 Enterprise Service: Enterprise Business Processes for Internal Identity Management.
5. MGMT-01-01-S Technology Portfolio Foundation – Application Standard.
6. POL-01-01-PR Technology Policies and Standards Waiver Procedure.
7. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose.
8. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance.
9. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security.
10. SEC-02-01-S Application Security Standard.
11. SEC-04-05-S Network Security Standard.
12. SEC-06 Access Control Policy.
13. SEC-06-01-S Identification and Authentication Security Standard.
14. SEC-06-02-S Remote Access Standard.
15. SEC-08-01-S Data Classification Standard.
16. SEC-08-02-S Encryption Standard.
17. Enterprise Security Standards.

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.